

Exploring Network Statistics with 'netstat'



netstat is generally used to find the various network connections a machine has, but has other functionalities too. It may be considered obsolete by some, but can be a handy tool when network issues have to be debugged.

‘netstat’, also known as network statistics, is most commonly used for displaying current network connections in devices/machines. However, it can also be used for printing the routing table, network card statistics, etc, of the machines.

In Linux, netstat is obsolete and hence it is recommended to use a combination of *ss* and *ip cli* utilities. That being said, it is still shipped by default with major Linux distributions, and is also a cross-platform tool available in BSD systems, MacOS and even Windows. So it's a good tool to keep in your toolset.

Understanding netstat output

While using a browser, you will definitely have a bunch of network connections. netstat is generally used to find all the network connections a machine has.

```
> netstat | head
```

Active Internet connections (w/o servers)

```
Proto Recv-Q Send-Q Local Address Foreign Address State
tcp 0 0 ary:54960 a104-113-212-245.:https ESTABLISHED
tcp 0 0 ary:54958 a104-113-212-245.:https ESTABLISHED
tcp 0 0 ary:40910 52.98.58.34:https ESTABLISHED
tcp 0 0 ary:38398 52.114.159.60:https ESTABLISHED
tcp 0 0 ary:55748 13.69.109.131:https ESTABLISHED
tcp 0 0 ary:48510 52.98.59.18:https ESTABLISHED
tcp 0 0 ary:44802 lb-140-82-113-26.:https ESTABLISHED
tcp 0 0 ary:46554 ec2-65-1-252-10.a:https ESTABLISHED
```

The meaning of the individual columns in the output above is as follows.

Column name	Description
Proto	The protocol used by the socket; e.g., TCP, UDP
Recv-Q	If the connection has already been established, as is the case with the above output, then it refers to the count of bytes that are not copied by the user program that is connected to this socket
Send-Q	Refers to the count of bytes not acknowledged by the remote host in this established connection state
Local address	Address and port number of the local end of the socket
Foreign address	Address and port number of the remote end of the socket
State	State of the socket: Listen, Established, etc.